Market Insights

SUSHI CAT SORT

Why Make Sushi Cat Sort?

A strategic choice based on market data and category trends

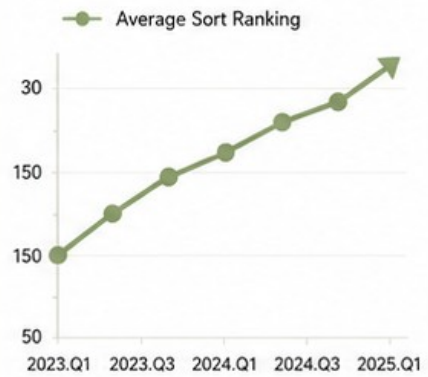


Why Choose a Sort Game?

Sort games are a blue ocean category with low competition, high potential, and sustiainable growth.

Key Metric	Data / Conclusion	Explanation
Low Competition	HHI < 0.05	Low market concentration, small teams still have opportunities
Rising Category Trend	Rankings continue to climb	Sort games rank higher over time
Strong Stability	Avg. lifespan longer than other casual categories	Durable category with fewer declines
Free Chart Potential	High chance to reach free charts	Proven to work, low competition, high breakout potential

Sort Game Ranking Trend (Example)



User Fit: Core users are 25–44-year-old women (61.13% on Magic Sort iOS). Male players are also not excluded, providing a solid foundation for category growth.

Why Add Simulation + Collection + Gamble Mechanics?

A Market Data Support

- 34% increase in monetization: Daily rewards and longer playtime
- Over 70% of non-RPG games adopt collection systems
- Adding progression and IAP boosts revenue by 20–40%
- Around 50% of top-grossing casual games in 2025 include light gamble mechanics
- Sort + collection visuals create a natural and satisfying loop



B The Core Loop of Gamble Mechanics



Use "Cat Recruit Tickets" for direct draws / downloads → Obtain resources via progression, unlock steps, and enable monetization → Set up a rarity system to ease "no-drop" frustration → Create a positive loop: Healthy challenge → Reward sense → Stronger stickiness

Summary

Why Make Sushi Cat Sort



Summary

- Sort games are a blue-ocean category with strong growth demand.
- Simulation management and cat IP can bring 20-40% higher IAP potential.
- Sushi + Cat + East Asian style creates differentiation and can be enhanced by AI assets.
- A three-layer market strategy supports sustainable global growth.

3. Why Use Cats and Sushi as the UI / Theme

A. Proven Cat Market Data

- Cat-themed assets improve CTR by 20-30%.
- Cat-related keywords reduce CPC by about 15%.
- 4 of the top 5 sorting games use Japanese-style or anime assets.
- Cats are loved worldwide and have strong user engagement.

B. Appeal of Sushi

- Sushi is one of the top three globally recognized cuisines.
- Highly popular in Asian, European, and American markets.
- Associated with relaxation, healing, and refined lifestyle.
- 80% of casual players enjoy food-themed games.

C. Differentiated East Asian Style Assets

- Unique art style with strong market recognition.
- AI art can be polished into high-quality Japanese-style assets.
- Visual style creates clear differentiation from other sort products.



1.1 Project Overview



Sorting Puzzle × **Simulation Management** × **Cat Nurturing**

The product uses sushi sorting as the core gameplay, driven by orders, star feedback, and a coin loop, connecting shop management and cat nurturing.

Take Orders → Sort & Serve → Earn Stars → Earn Coins → Unlock Growth → Next Level

- 1.2 Core Concept
- 1.3 Sorting Mechanism
- 1.4 Simulation Elements
- 1.5 Controls
- 1.6 Rating System
- 1.7 Currency & Item System

Target Experience: In a healing atmosphere, turn chaos into order and gradually build a legendary cat sushi shop.

1.2 Core Concept

A healing casual game combining **Sushi Sorting**, **Shop Management**, and **Cat Nurturing**.



Core Definition

- Use sushi sorting as the core gameplay to complete level objectives.
- Use order-driven progression to give each level a clear goal.
- Use star feedback and coins to build long-term motivation.
- Use shop management and cat nurturing to extend gameplay and emotional connection.

Gameplay Combination





Core Loop





Core Goal: In a healing atmosphere, turn chaos into order and gradually build a legendary cat sushi shop.

1.3 Sorting Mechanism

The sorting screen and is the core gameplay scene; players accept orders, move sushi, and complete dishes.



Order Panel
Displays the cat avatar and order details.

Status Panel
Shows step count, time left, and preview rating.

Tray Area
4–6 sushi containers; players sort here.

Action Buttons
Undo / Shuffle / Add Tube



Feature Overview

Order Panel	Displays the cat avatar and order details.
Status Panel	Shows step count, time left, and preview rating.
Tray Area	4–6 sushi containers, where players sort.
Action Buttons	Undo / Shuffle / Add Tube

Core Rule

Each container holds up to 3 sushi pieces, and only the top sushi can be moved.



Core Flow

Accept Order → Move Sushi → Match Types and Quantity → Auto-Serve Dish



1.4 Simulation Management Elements



Each level is a meal order posted by cat customers; the player's goal is to complete it by sorting orders and matching specified categories and quantities.



Cat Order
Cat customers post a meal order.



Sorting Order
Sort orders and match specified categories and quantities.



Serve Dish
Serve the dish to earn rewards.



Store Growth
Unlock new elements and expand content.





01 Order Driven
Make objectives clear and achievable.

02 Serving Feedback
Make results satisfying and create a sense of achievement.

03 Management Chain
Link results to store growth.



Sorting is not just tidying colors; it is about serving customers and fulfilling their meal orders.

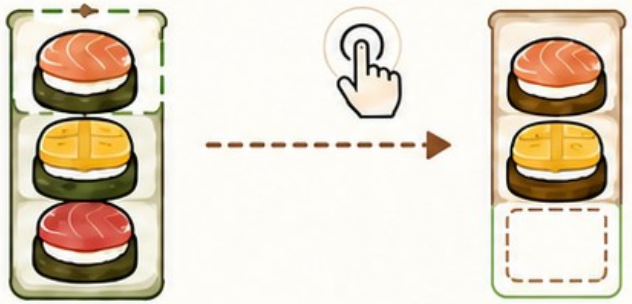


1.5 Operation Rules



1 Basic Operation

Tap any container to select the top sushi; then tap the target container to complete the move.



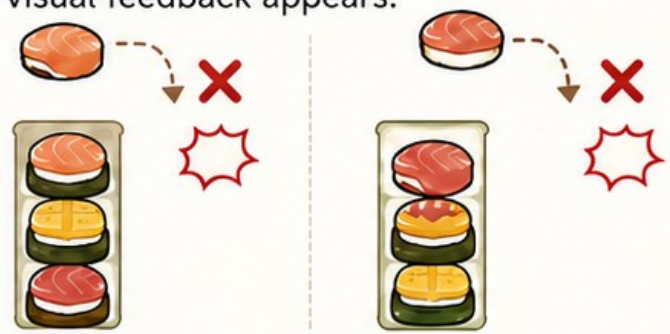
2 Legal Move Conditions

- The target container is empty and can accept any type of sushi.
- Or the top sushi in the target container is the same type as the moving sushi, and the target container is not full (<3).



3 Illegal Move

If the target container is full, or the sushi types do not match and the target is not empty, the move is invalid and visual feedback appears.



Win / Loss Mechanism

Complete the order set and auto-serve.

Complete all orders to win.

If no empty container is available for the next move, the level fails.





1.6 Rating Mechanism

Mechanism Logic



Core logic: After the player accepts an order, the game enters a waiting state.
If the player makes wrong moves or moves too slowly, the hunger value decreases;
the final star rating is determined by the remaining hunger value.

Hunger Value Mechanism (Core Concept)



Initial Hunger Value
100%

Minimum Hunger Value
0%
(When hunger reaches 0, the level ends immediately.)

Hunger Decreases
(The timer starts after the player's first move.)

Depletion Speed Curve (Stage-Based)

Stage	Time Range	Depletion Speed	Player Feel
Early Stage	0–30 sec	0% per sec (No depletion)	Focus on learning the rules
Normal Stage	30–60 sec	0.5% per sec	Gentle pressure, encourages action
Urgent Stage	60–90 sec	1.5% per sec	Push for faster decisions, create challenge

Design Intent

- The low depletion in the early stage lets new players study the board without stress.
- The increasing depletion in later stages raises the stakes and enhances the challenge.



1.6 Rating System

Feedback & Thresholds



Each time players successfully clear a column of 3 identical sushi, hunger value increases by **+15%**, up to **100%**.



Recovery Feedback



Hunger bar bounces up with green sparkle.



Cat avatar shows a happy expression with heart effect.



Light ding sound strengthens the reward feeling.

Rating Thresholds

★★★	3 Stars: >=70%
★★	2 Stars: 40%-70%
★	1 Star: 10%-40%



Compensation Rules

0%

If hunger reaches 0, it is considered failure, but the player can still retry.

Clearing sushi can restore some time and offer a board-flip chance.

The highest historical score is kept and will not be downgraded.





1.7 Currency & Item System | Acquisition & Payment





Single Currency: Coins

All in-game content purchases use Coins directly, keeping the store system simple and consistent.

Free Acquisition (Free-to-Earn)

Source	Amount (Example)	Trigger Conditions
Milestone Rewards	100 – 450 Coins	Pass levels / Star ratings
Daily Check-in	50 – 500 Coins / Day	Consecutive check-ins increase rewards
Daily Challenges	240 – 480 Coins	Complete daily challenge cards

Fast-paced and high star ratings lead to more Coins earned per run.

Paid Acquisition (IAP)

	Item	Price (CNY)	Coins (Example)	Description
	Small Coin Pack	¥6	200	Light top-up
	Standard Gift Pack	¥18	700	Great value
	Premium Gift Pack	¥30	1,500	Best value
	Monthly Card	¥15 / Month	Daily +60, 30 days	Sustained returns

All paid content grants Coins only. No gameplay advantage is provided.

Design Principle: Purchases only accelerate acquisition, not affect core gameplay fairness; to ensure long-term value and flexible progression.

Coins serve as the unified economic entry in the system, driving a closed loop of “milestone rewards – item consumption – growth interaction”.

1.7 Currency & Item Systems | Costs and Balance



Consumable Items
(Level Helper)

Undo	Undo last move	100 Coins
Shuffle	Shuffle the current layout	200 Coins
Extra Slot	Add one extra slot	300 Coins

Cat Items
(Collection & Upgrade)

Snacks	Dried fish / Milk / Canned food	100–500 Coins
Toys	Yarn ball / Toy mouse / Cat stick	500–1000 Coins
Furniture	Upgrade environment furniture	1000–2000 Coins

Balance Design Principles

- Coins are mainly used for acceleration and cosmetics, not essential for progression.
- Item acquisition is natural and steady, ensuring long-term player retention.
- Pricing is well-balanced, encouraging players to complete tasks and take on challenges.
- Paid content is optimized to have minimal impact on fairness and core fun.

Balance Goal: Ensure paid items enhance convenience, while free players can still achieve a strong sense of accomplishment and long-term enjoyment.

SUSHI CAT SORT

2.1 World Setting



A Background Setting

- In a parallel world where cats and humans coexist in harmony, humans run a fine dining restaurant that cat customers love.
- Legend has it that a “master sushi chef cat” runs this restaurant, serving exquisite sushi feasts. However, to maintain perfection, the kitchen must be kept neat and well-organized.
- Players take on the role of this legendary chef cat, starting from a small corner shop and gradually building it into a world-famous sushi restaurant.



B Chapter Design

Chapter	Content	Unlock Condition
 **1.** Chapter 1: Corner Shop	Wooden counter, basic sushi, 5 initial cat customers	Initial state
 **2.** Chapter 2: New District Store	Modern design, roll sushi unlocked, 10 cat customers	Unlock at Stage 15
 **3.** Chapter 3: City Landmark	Japanese-style decor, seasonal special sushi, rare cat customers	Unlock at Stage 30
 **4.** Chapter 4: Meow Michelin	Luxury performance, story sushi, ultra-rare cat customers	Unlock at Stage 45



Each chapter includes 15 stages. Progress through stages to unlock content and upgrade cat customers, providing a continuous sense of achievement and discovery.



2.1 Difficulty Parameters

Difficulty Parameters

Parameter	★ Easy	★ Medium	★ Hard
Sushi Types	3 ~ 4 types	5 ~ 6 types	7 ~ 8 types
Target Orders	3 ~ 5 orders	6 ~ 8 orders	9 ~ 12 orders
Star Threshold (3 stars)	⩾ 50%	⩾ 60%	⩾ 70%
Coin Reward Cap	~100 coins	~240 coins	~480 coins
Cat Pool	Normal	Normal + Rare	Rare + Super Rare

Timing Settings

Difficulty	Grace Period	Normal Time	Rush Period	Total Time
★ Easy	40 sec	30 sec	20 sec	90 sec
★ Medium	30 sec	30 sec	30 sec	90 sec
★ Hard	15 sec	30 sec	45 sec	90 sec

Difficulty scaling is achieved by increasing the variety of sushi, the number of orders, the star threshold, and time pressure in sync.

2.1 Difficulty Escalation

Difficulty increases through more task pressure, disruptive mechanics, and more simultaneous operations.

1 More Orders



One cat customer must complete more orders before the next customer appears.

2 Special Sushi



Seaweed sushi introduces visual blocking, making the tray harder to read and creating new in-level obstacles.

3 Special Mechanism



After an order is completed, one tray enters a cleaning round and cannot be used until cleaning finishes.

4 More Complex Interface



Players must manage more trays at the same time, increasing coordination pressure.

Core Idea: Difficulty grows through order volume, disruptive elements, temporary tray loss, and increased multitasking.

2.2 Foster System

Kitten Recruitment



Use the teaser toy to attract kittens to Sushi Cat House.

Recruitment Process



1. Complete stage missions
2. Earn recruitment opportunities
3. Use teaser toy to attract a kitten
4. Kitten joins your collection

After earning recruitment opportunities, using the teaser toy may attract different kittens that join your collection.

Why Use Teaser Toys to Recruit?

A Boosts compatibility:
Recruitment actions are more aligned with kitten behavior.



B Stronger emotional bond:
Teaser toys create anticipation and positive feelings.



C Better display:
Kittens appear in more engaging moments.



D Smoother cycle:
Rewards naturally flow back into the collection loop.





The core value of the Foster System:
Turning short-term interactions into long-term collection momentum.



2.2 Progression System

Cat Care: Affection Mechanisms

Method	Description	Affection Gained
Daily Check-In	Log in to the game daily	+1
Feed Snacks	Feed dried fish, cat milk, or canned food	+1 / +2 / +3
Give Toys	Provide yarn balls, toy mice, or teaser wands	+2 / +3 / +5
Invest in Furniture	Invest in furniture or decorative items	+10

Core Benefits

- Build long-term companionship
- Encourage ongoing engagement
- Turn resource spending into emotional value

The progression system turns resource usage into lasting companionship.

SUSHI CAT SORT

Build Your Cat Home

Through feeding, decoration, and interaction, increase cat satisfaction, earn item rewards, and build a long-term sense of companionship.



1. Empty Room → 2. Basic Layout → 3. Intermediate Layout → 4. Advanced Layout → 5. Ultimate Layout





① Cat Nest Upgrade

Increase satisfaction and unlock a cozier cat nest



② Public Area Expansion

Decorate and expand to unlock more areas



③ More Cats

Adopt stray cats and grow your cat family



④ Richer Furniture

Unlock more furniture and decorations



⑤ A Busier Shop

More cat interactions and more visiting customers

Core Goal: Combine management and nurturing to make the cat sushi shop warmer and livelier!

Satisfaction System

Upgrading cat-home furniture can improve cat satisfaction.
The higher the level, the better the reward items and the higher the gift frequency.





Effects of Satisfaction

Low Satisfaction



- Cats sleep and stay inactive
- Affinity growth stops
- No more gift items

High Satisfaction



- Cats become lively and interact proactively
- Gift-item channel is enabled
- Item quality and frequency increase
- More interaction animations are unlocked

Core Goal: Help players build an emotional bond with cats and gain long-term companionship and rewards.

Daily Interaction Flow

Log in every day, care for cats, upgrade your cat home, and receive feedback—continuously operate and grow.



1 One-tap Feed



Feed cats to gather them together and create a warm and cozy home.

2 Increase Affinity



Use treats to increase cat affinity and strengthen your bond.

3 Upgrade Home



Upgrade furniture, expand public areas, and unlock more interactions and decorations.

4 Manage & Operate



Play Sort levels, complete orders, earn coins and resources, and grow your shop.

Core Goal: Make daily care, home upgrading, and shop management work together to bring more warmth, excitement, and long-term companionship between the player and their cats.

2.2 System Feedback Loop Overview



1. Complete a level → Trigger cat recruitment
2. System determines pull difficulty → Randomly draw from the cat pool
3. New cat joins and becomes available
4. Player feeds / interacts → Provides toys to boost affection
5. Affection reaches a threshold → Unlock support abilities
6. Clear the next level → Get assistance
7. Return to step 1 to continue the loop



The localization system forms a long-term feedback loop through **"Clear–Recruit–Nurture–Support–Repeat."**



2.3 Collection System

Gallery — Sushi Encyclopedia

The Sushi Encyclopedia records all sushi collected in the game. Collect different types of sushi to earn rewards.



Tuna Nigiri

✓ Collected



Tamago Nigiri

✓ Collected



Seared Salmon Nigiri

✓ Collected



???

🔒 Locked



???

🔒 Locked



???

🔒 Locked

Unlock Conditions

Status	Condition	Display
Locked	Not yet obtained	Silhouette
Collected	Complete the order that includes this sushi for the first time	Full details

Completion Rewards

Completion	Reward
5 types	"Sushi Apprentice" title + 200 Coins
10 types	"Sushi Chef" title + 500 Coins
15 types (Full Collection)	"Sushi Master" title + 1000 Coins

The collection system provides unlock progress and reward feedback, strengthening long-term goals and sustaining player engagement.

SUSHI CAT SORT

2.4 Daily Challenge



What is Daily Challenge?

- A high-difficulty level that resets every day
- Players can challenge it once per day. Complete it to earn rewards, then it resets the next day.
- An important feature for returning players and a key driver of resource acquisition.



Mechanics

Attempts	1 time per day
Difficulty	Hard
Stage Content	Stages change daily
Failure Handling	No attempt deduction; can retry until cleared
Reset Time	Resets daily at 00:00

Challenge Rewards

A Fixed Reward



240~480 Coins

B Random Reward



Cat Food ×1 or



Toy ×1

Complete multiple days in a row to unlock streak rewards!

7 Days



Rare Cat

14 Days



Furniture ×1

30 Days



Special Title + Super Rare Cat

The Daily Challenge, with its **"low frequency, high stability"** approach, continuously drives player return, which is essential for maintaining the core daily active user **(DAU)** and **retention** systems.



SUSHI CAT SORT

2.5 Core Experience



> "In a soothing atmosphere, we turn intelligent order into satisfying delight"

Three Core Pillars

Pillar 1: Immediate Feedback

- **Cognitive Basis:** Humans have a drive for categorization and organization (Completion Compulsion)
- Every completed level = a small, clear sense of achievement
- All levels completed = a strong, sequential sense of achievement

Pillar 2: Soothing Atmosphere

- The cute art style enhances trustworthy behavior and activates nurturing instincts, which helps reduce stress
- Themed elements (cats, emotions, sushi) give meaning to sorting behavior
- Global constraints: no timers, no penalties for failure, no death, no violent elements

Pillar 3: Strategic Depth

- **Early game:** intuitive and easy to learn
- **Mid game:** requires 2–3 steps of look-ahead planning, managing temporary storage
- **Late game:** special sushi and tools introduce strategic resource use
- Strategic depth is optional, not mandatory

Core Loops

Micro Loop: Observe → Plan → Choose → Move → Evaluate → Complete

Macro Loop: Star Rating → Unlock Gallery → Store Upgrade → Progress → New Levels

Emotional Curve

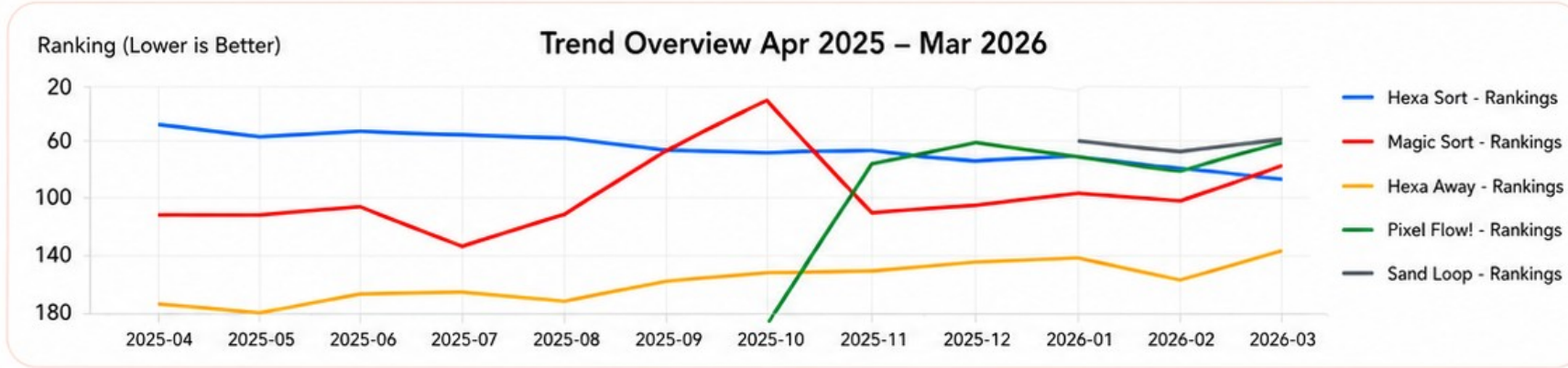
Curiosity (Stage 1)	Flow (Stage 2)	Fulfillment (Stage 3)	Anticipation (Stage 4)
Curiosity → Focus	Focus → Immersion	Immersion → Satisfaction	Satisfaction → Anticipation



The core experience is not about completing levels in order, but about continuously gaining a sense of order and control in a soothing atmosphere, which leads to a sense of fulfillment and anticipation.



3.1 Case Study



Core Gameplay

The classic water sort puzzle: pour water by color between bottles to sort all colors into the same bottle. Later levels add hidden colors, specific color bottles, new mechanics, and constraints, deepening strategy.

Feature System Examples

Magic Streak

Combo streaks earn multiplier rewards.

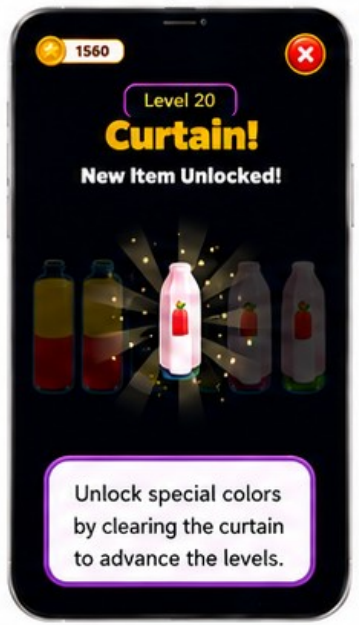
x1	x5	x10	x25	x100

Daily Challenge

Complete daily tasks to earn coins and rewards.

100	30m	500	2500

Gameplay Screenshots



Curtain Unlock



Standard Level



No Moves / Revive

Core Resources & Economy

Core Resources

Lives
Lost when starting a level. Recover through daily tasks, rewards, or in-app purchases.

Coins
Used in the shop for items or hints. Relatively scarce.

Monetization System

IAA	Interstitials, banners, native ads
IAP	Packs, remove ads, VIP, etc.

The game builds sustainable engagement through a "Mainline Levels + Reward System + Daily Challenges" loop.

3.2 User Acquisition and Images

User Acquisition

Downloads

3,945,710

Last 30 days

Revenue

$7,992,938

Last 30 days

Customer Acquisition Cost & Efficiency (Relative to actual implementation)

CPI Android	CPI iOS	IPM Android	IPM iOS	D1 Retention	ARPU*	LTV
↓ -32%	↓ -31%	↑ +78%	↑ +93%	↑ +26%	↑ +21%	↑ +16%

* ARPU refers to the average revenue in the first 30 days after installation (used as the denominator when comparing with traffic acquisition cost).

Download Sources (Share of download volume)



Revenue Sources (Share of revenue)



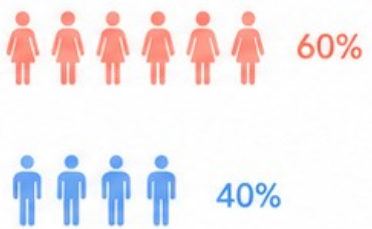
User Images

Primarily users aged 25–44, with a male to female ratio of approximately 2:3, females slightly higher.

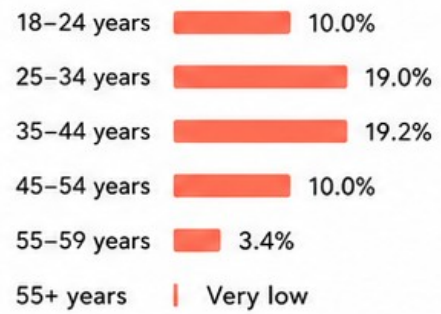
Users aged 55+ are at a very low proportion.

Gender Distribution

(Approximately 2:3)



Age Distribution (%)





Competitive users are primarily lightly engaged players aged 25–44, and their growth and monetization potential are more concentrated in mature markets.

3.2 Retention Experience and User Behavior

Retention Experience

Explanation of key features by stage:

- 39 open Teams systems
- 40 open Leaderboard systems
- 95 open Collection systems

Unlocked with delay to maintain player expectations for the new system, prolong game life cycle, and reduce early churn.

6 Core Feature Modules

- Home
- Level Mode LevelXX
- Daily Challenge
- Shop
- Leaderboard
- Teams
- Collection

User Behavior Characteristics

- Average opens per day: **3–5** times
- Average single session duration: **3.1–6.7** minutes
- Average total daily play time: **15–20** minutes

Typical fragmented usage scenarios: commuting, queuing, waiting in line, etc.

Players use the game in short bursts.

User Needs and Feedback



- **Core needs:** Relaxation, time-killing, airport waiting, bedtime gameplay.
- **User attitude toward ads:** Acceptable ads, but strong aversion to forced ads (fake rewards, overly intrusive ads after viewing that don't grant rewards.
- **Stickiness and churn:** Core players show high stickiness (1200+ common levels), but frustration with mandatory ads leads to rapid churn.
- **Exploration and demand:** Players prefer challenge and lightweight puzzle-solving, are less tolerant of strategy or AI-assisted content, and are highly sensitive to excessive ad exposure.

Competitors maintain retention through "staged unlocking + high-frequency fragmented usage," but experience ceilings and ad tolerance are extremely sensitive.

3.3 Competitor Analysis

Competitor Quick View

- **Core Gameplay** (Water Sort)
- **Key Systems** (Mainline + Challenges + Rewards)
- **Monetization** (IAA + IAP)
- **Target Users** (25–44 Casual Players)

Effective Practices

- Intuitive water-sort rules, low entry barrier, easy to learn
- Mainline + daily challenges + streak rewards create continuous motivation
- Features unlock by stages and extend the lifecycle
- Clear resource and monetization loop, clear paid points

Key Pain Points

- **Ad issues:** high frequency, long duration, redirect failures, and poor ad experience
- **Paywall:** difficulty spikes around levels 60–100, with imbalanced item and coin consumption
- **Luck-based mechanism:** hidden colors weaken solvability and create repeated frustration
- **Technical bugs:** crashes, progress loss, mistaken coin consumption, and poor offline experience

Implications for This Project

- Transparent ad frequency to avoid a “scammed” feeling
- Smooth difficulty curve and fewer forced payment points
- Skill should matter more than luck to ensure solvability
- Prioritize stability to reduce bugs and progress-loss risks

In short, competitors prove the potential of the gameplay, but their main churn points are concentrated in ads, difficulty, luck-based mechanisms, and stability.

4.2 Sound Design

Sound Experience Map

01



Sushi Layering

Crisp wooden impact sounds when layers are stacked successfully

02



Kitty Meows

Random pitch variations, 3–5 tone pools; triggers on tap to encourage feeding and prevent repetition

03



Star Complete

Gentle chime + short melodic jingle; strong sense of reward upon completion

04



Background Music

Soothing Lo-Fi (normal) / cute & upbeat rhythm (mild tension alert)

Sound Feedback Loop

Action
Player performs a tap

↓

Feedback
Appropriate sound response

↓

Emotional Memory
Pleasant, reassuring experience

↓

Next Tap
Forms a positive repeat loop



Sound Goal: Low-pressure, lighthearted, and replayable—let sound gently guide, not suddenly startle.

Monetization Design

Hybrid Casual Commercialization Design,
Market Entry, and Growth Model



IAA Advertising Monetization

Rewarded Ads +
Interstitial Ads

IAP In-App Purchase Monetization

Ad-free, booster packs,
gift bundles

ROI / LTV / CAC

User Value and
Scalable Growth

Goal: Build a verifiable-ROI, scalable-user-acquisition, and sustainable Hybrid Casual business model.

0.1 Commercialization Blueprint



Cat Sushi Sort builds a Hybrid Casual model through 'Sort Puzzle x Cat Raising x Store Growth' and achieves growth and monetization through IAA + IAP.

01 Product Positioning



- Package sorting gameplay with a cat sushi theme
- Emotional value + light raising + store growth
- Light monetization within a Hybrid Casual framework

02 Market Strategy

- United States: validate user acquisition and ad efficiency
- Japan: validate high-quality users and IAP conversion
- South Korea / Southeast Asia: absorb overflow traffic and supplement IAA scale

03 Growth Roadmap

- M0-M6: validate LTV/CAC > 1.0
- M6-M12: push toward 1.2-1.5
- M12+: move toward long-term operations and IP development

Summary: Build a commercial closed loop with verifiable ROI, sustainable user acquisition, and long-term operating potential.



0.2 Core Judgments

This is not a pure ad-driven game.
It is a Hybrid Casual plan that builds a verifiable ROI through IAA + IAP.



Product Judgment

- Cats + sushi + sorting have strong creative appeal
- Store growth provides medium- and long-term goals
- Cat emotion + store progression improve ad and payment conversion

Market Judgment

- The United States is responsible for user acquisition and creative learning
- Japan is responsible for validating high-quality users and long-term payment
- South Korea / Southeast Asia absorb expansion after the model is validated

Growth Judgment

- Do not maximize revenue in the first 30 days
- Prioritize D1 / CPI / CTR / CVR / D7 and D30 ROAS
- Validate whether it can scale before increasing spend

Product Packaging → User Acquisition Efficiency → Ad / Payment Conversion → Scale Growth

Key idea: Validate the model first, then pursue scale.

1.1 M0-M6: Model Validation Phase



Use minimal investment to validate Cat Sushi Sort's retention quality, ad acceptance, IAP payment potential, and ROI path.

A Retention Quality



- D1 Retention > 38%
- D7 Retention > 18%
- D30 Retention > 8%

B Hybrid Monetization Validation



- Rewarded video view rate > 55%
- US rewarded eCPM > $8
- Japan rewarded eCPM > $10
- 30-day IAP conversion rate > 2%
- D30 ARPU (US) $0.50-$0.70

C User Acquisition Efficiency



- US CPI < $3.5
- Japan CPI < $4.0
- K-Factor > 0.4
- By M6, LTV/CAC approaches break-even
- Referral sharing system launched

D Bottom-Line Signals



- Blended-channel scaling, base case D270, optimistic case D180
- Retention rate > 8%
- DAU > 5,000



Phase goal: Confirm user value and acquisition efficiency before scaling.

1.2 M6-M12: Scaling Phase



After PMF is validated, expand commercialization through LiveOps, creative iteration, and organic traffic growth.

A Core Market Performance

- US iOS Puzzle Top Grossing rank: Top 100-200
- Japan iOS Puzzle Top Grossing rank: Top 200-300
- Organic traffic share > 20%

B Revenue Scale

- M12 monthly revenue target: $150k-$250k
- IAA revenue share: 60-70%
- IAP revenue share: 30-40%

C User Quality

- US + Japan DAU: 20,000-50,000
- US D180 LTV > $1.50
- LTV/CAC ≥ 1.5
- K-Factor > 0.6

D LiveOps Capability

- More than 2 festival / themed events per month
- More than 20 new levels every two weeks
- Version iteration cycle < 4 weeks

Stage goal: Upgrade from “validated” to “sustainably growing”.

1.3 M12+: IP Brand Operations Phase



Upgrade from a single product into a sustainably operated cat-themed IP asset.

A Category Position

- Become a representative title within the Sort Puzzle segment
- Core-market single-channel D360 ROI > 100%
- D365 Retention > 8%

B Revenue Scale

- M24 annualized revenue target: $3M-$5M
- Organic traffic share > 30%

C Mature Business Model

- IAA covers daily monetization from free users
- IAP supports cat collection, decoration, and long-term growth
- Use LTV/CAC, D30 ROAS, and creative win rate to drive UA decisions

D IP Expansion Potential

- At least 5 recognizable core mascot characters
- Explore merchandise, collaborations, and IP licensing
- Lay the foundation for sequels / spin-offs

Validation Phase
Product validation and market fit

Growth Phase
Scale growth and efficiency optimization

IP Operations Phase
Brand accumulation and long-term value expansion

Key idea: Build an emotional moat, not just a one-off hit.

2.0 Market Entry Overview



Start with scale in the United States, use Japan to validate core profit quality, and treat South Korea and Southeast Asia as follow-on expansion markets.

Priority 1

United States



- High scale
- High eCPM
- Validates user acquisition and ad efficiency

Priority 2

Japan



- High monetization quality
- High IAP conversion
- Validates profit quality

Priority 3

South Korea



- High ARPU
- Cultural proximity
- High-quality expansion

Priority 4

Southeast Asia



- Low CPI
- Fast growth
- Low-cost IAA scale

United States (Scale) → **Japan** (Validation) → **South Korea / Southeast Asia** (Expansion)

Overall strategy: Prove the model first in high-validation-value markets, then expand coverage.

2.1 United States: Growth Engine



The United States is responsible for validating the user acquisition model, creative efficiency, and advertising monetization capability.

Core Advantages

- **World's largest mobile game market** – IAP revenue is approximately $52 billion, ranking first globally.
- **Highest ad eCPM ceiling** – iOS rewarded video eCPM is about $13.18, indicating a high upper bound for IAA monetization.
- **Established category awareness** – Users have already been educated by products such as Magic Sort, so there is no need to explain what a sorting game is.
- **Mature ad-based acquisition infrastructure** – Facebook, TikTok, and Unity Ads are fully established, with high creative testing efficiency.
- **More predictable payback** – iOS D30 ROAS is around 47%, so the payback period for casual games is more predictable.
- **English = global lingua franca** – Once produced, creatives can be reused across Commonwealth and other English-speaking markets.

Major Risks and Responses

Risk	**High CPI ($2.5-$3.0 for iOS)**
Response	Lower effective CPI by leveraging high eCPM and referral mechanisms.
Risk	**Fierce competition (Magic Sort, etc.)**
Response	Differentiate with the positioning: 'Ad-free Experience + Cat Raising'.
Risk	**Non-optimal cultural fit**
Response	Cat IPs are universally recognized, and sushi as a 'healthy exotic food' is well accepted in the United States.

Role of the US market: validate scalable acquisition and ad efficiency, rather than simply pursuing short-term payback.

2.2 Japan: Profit Core



Japan is used to validate high-quality users, long-term retention, and IAP conversion, making it the key market for monetization quality.

Japan Advantage Breakdown

1. Users have high payment quality

- Japan's overall mobile gaming market has very high ARPU: it generated about $11 billion in revenue (ranking 2nd in Asia) with only 628 million downloads (ranking 9th in Asia).
- The ARPU of the sort / casual puzzle category in Japan is approximately 60%-80% of that in the United States ($0.5-$1.5 per install), yet it boasts a high paid conversion rate and premium user quality.
- Japanese users have a high acceptance of low-priced bundles (¥120-480), with stable per-user IAP spending, making the market suitable for refined LTV operations.

2. Decoding the Category Dominance

- Casual puzzle games account for 33.2% of total downloads in Japan, ranking first among all categories.
- Sort genre games (such as Car Jam and Screw Sort 3D) registered a year-on-year growth rate of over 70%.
- Titles such as Block Blast! and Color Block Jam account for one-third of the download market share in Japan.

3. Cat IP Precedent Effect

- Neko Atsume, developed by Hit-Point, has over 20 million global downloads and still more than 20,000 monthly active users in the US.
- Cat-themed games have natural social communication appeal in Japan.

Risks and Entry Strategy

The market shrunk slightly (-2.2%)	Downloads declined slightly, but overall monetization quality remains high.
High user acquisition threshold	CPI is not low; we must rely on stronger paid conversion, long-term retention, and refined operations to improve LTV.
High localization requirements	Native-level Japanese localization is required, not just direct translation.
Moderation may be more stringent	Google Play Japan / App Store Japan process standards must be respected.

Role of Japan: not the largest traffic pool, but the most important market for profit quality and high-value user validation.

2.3 South Korea and Southeast Asia: Expansion and Volume Supplement



After the model is validated in the United States and Japan, South Korea and Southeast Asia will respectively take on high-ARPU expansion and low-cost IAA volume supplementation.

3 South Korea: Third Priority

- Worth entering, with the third priority.
- Advantages: cultural proximity, Android-dominant structure (lower CPI), and high ARPU.
- However, the market size is only about 1/9 of that of the United States, and heavy gaming dominates attention.
- It is suitable for natural overflow after the model has been proven in the US and Japan.

4 Southeast Asia: Fourth Priority

- Key focus: Thailand, Indonesia, Vietnam, the Philippines, Malaysia, and Singapore.

Country	CPI (Android)	Characteristics
Thailand	$0.5-1.2	Strong reach of Japanese / Korean pop culture; broad anime audience
Indonesia	$0.3-0.8	Demographic dividend (270M population); Android dominates absolutely
Vietnam	$0.4-1.0	Young population; mobile-first market
Singapore	$1.5-3.0	ARPU comparable to developed markets; English-language environment
Malaysia	$0.5-1.2	Multilingual (English / Malay / Chinese)

Overall Region

- Southeast Asia's mobile game spending growth is the fastest worldwide (+14%-21%).
- CPI is among the world's lowest tiers (Android: $0.3-1.5).
- However, ARPU is also the lowest, with eCPM only around $0.5-2.
- It is suitable for an IAA-based model; IAP paid rate is low.
- Acquire massive users at low cost, but do not expect high ARPU. Suitable for reach using remaining advertising inventory / natural traffic after the US-Japan model is established. Focus on Thailand and Indonesia.
- Note: Local-language versions (Thai / Indonesian) are required for effective penetration.

Key conclusion: South Korea is for higher-quality expansion, while Southeast Asia is for low-cost scale; both should follow validation in the US and Japan.



3.0 Core Metrics Framework

Monetization tracking is divided into five layers: user quality, acquisition, ad monetization, payment, and payback.

1 User Quality

- D1 / D7 / D30 Retention
- Session Length
- Session Frequency

2 Acquisition Efficiency

- CPI
- CTR
- CVR

3 Ad Monetization

- eCPM
- Fill Rate
- Rewarded Opt-in
- Ad ARPDAU

Total LTV



4 Payment Performance

- Paid Rate
- ARPPU
- First Purchase
- Repeat Purchase

5 Payback Evaluation

- D7 / D30 ROAS
- LTV / CAC
- ROI



Key judgment: do not chase a single revenue peak; confirm an explainable ROI path.



3.1 Retention Targets

Retention is the lifeline of Hybrid Casual monetization. It determines whether ads and IAP can accumulate LTV.

D1 Retention

⩾38%

The new-user experience is accepted



D7 Retention

⩾18%

Monetization lifeline



D30 Retention

⩾8%

Prerequisite for IAP conversion





Day 1 — Day 7 — Day 30

If retention is weak, optimize the onboarding levels, the emotional hook of the first cat, and the timing of ad triggers first.



3.2 Revenue Metrics

IAA Ad Revenue

- Rewarded eCPM: US > 8, Japan > 10
- Rewarded video view rate > 55%
- Ad ARPDAU measures daily ad revenue per user

IAP Revenue

- Paid rate > 2%
- D30 ARPU in the US: $0.50-$0.70
- Japan is 60%-80% of the US, about $0.30-$0.56, but paid conversion and long-term retention are better



IAA + IAP = Hybrid ARPDAU

Read revenue together with retention; do not look at single-day revenue alone.

3.3 LTV/CAC & ROAS



Monetization Decision Framework

LTV / CAC > 1.0

= Validated

User value exceeds acquisition cost.
The monetization direction is proven.

LTV / CAC > 1.2

= Sustainable Growth

Positive profit space.
Growth can be funded while efficiency is optimized.

LTV / CAC > 1.5

= Mature Growth

User value significantly exceeds cost, forming a healthy growth flywheel.

D7 D7: directional validation →

Validate whether LTV > CAC.



D30 D30: near break-even →

At first, let LTV/CAC approach 1.0-1.2.



D180 D180: enters the scaling zone

Then optimize efficiency and retention to enter a stable scaling stage.



ROAS Qualification for Scaling

D7 — ROAS Early Indicator

Assess creative quality, placement, and day-1 retention & conversion quality.

D30 — ROAS Scaling Qualification

Evaluate retention, LTV potential, and whether users are worth scaling.



The key is not short-term cash recovery alone, but whether acquired users can pay back their acquisition cost.



4.0 User Segmentation Model



High-Value Users 2%-3%

- Long-term retention, collection, and cat raising
- Monthly spend $20+; buy limited cats and high-value bundles
- Monthly card and ad removal pack





Hybrid Users 10%-15%

- Watch ads + light spending





Ad-Supported Users 80%-88%

- Mainly engage in the sorting gameplay
- Do not pay
- Contribute revenue through ads





Segmentation goal: use **IAA** to monetize the majority, and use **IAP** to capture users with higher emotional investment.



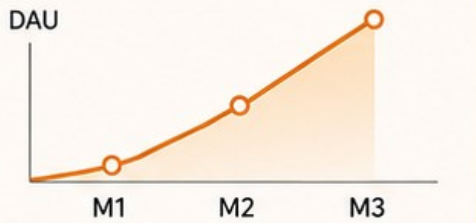
4.1 Revenue Forecast Logic

Revenue = DAU × ARPDAU × Days

- **DAU** — Daily active users
- **ARPDAU** — Revenue per active user per day
- **Days** — Observation period

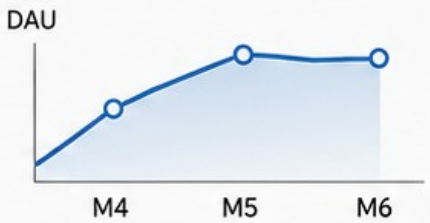


PHASE 1 — M1-M3 UA Validation



- DAU climbs rapidly
- Test product-ad fiit
- Build the initial data foundation

PHASE 2 — M4-M6 ROI Calibration



- Filter effective channels
- Optimize UA ROI
- Retain higher-quality channels

PHASE 3 — M7-M12 LiveOps Growth



- Maintain DAU through events and version updates
- Improve DAU and paid conversion through LiveOps

Validate D1 retention and ad acceptance first, then decide whether to scale acquisition.

4.2 LTV Model

LTV ≈ **ARPDAU**$_{avg}$ × **Lifetime**$_{days}$ × **Retention**$_{decay_factor}$

Benchmark

$0.031/day × 120 days × 0.53 = **$1.97**



Non-paying users

D180 LTV

$0.80 - $1.20



Light payers

D180 LTV

$3.50 - $6.00



Heavy payers

D180 LTV

$15 - $30

LTV is not single-day revenue. It is the total of IAA and IAP across the user lifetime.

4.3 ROI

US iOS

CPI	$3
D180 LTV	$1.97

Payback period (base case): break-even at D360.

US Android

CPI	$2
D180 ROAS	0.90

Payback period (base case): break-even at D210.

JP iOS

CPI	$4

Payback period (base case): break-even at D300.

JP Android

CPI	$2.8
D180 ROAS	0.93

Payback period (base case): break-even at D180 in the optimistic case.

Recommendation

Validate the lower-CPI path with JP Android and US Android first. Once D30 ROAS > 40%, scale iOS.

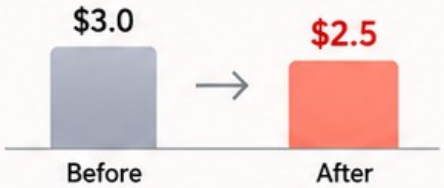
Mixed-channel payback is about D270; base-case single-channel iOS payback is about D360, so the definitions should be explained separately.

4.4 Sensitivity Analysis

How key variable changes affect payback period and LTV, validating model robustness and optimization priorities.

CPI

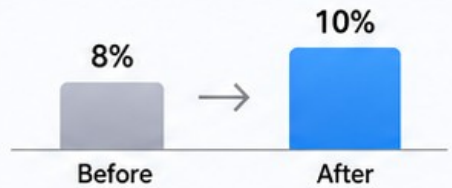
US iOS $3.0 → **$2.5**



Shortens the payback cycle from about D360 to about **D270**

D30 Retention

8% → **10%**



Raises **D180 LTV**

Impact on Payback Period

Rewarded eCPM

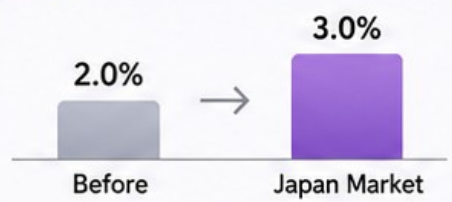
$10 → **$13**



Improves free-user LTV and shortens payback.

IAP Paid Rate

2.0% → **3.0%**



Raises LTV from mid- and high-value users, especially in Japan.

The highest-priority optimizations are not price changes, but CPI、retention、eCPM, and paid rate.

5.0 AI Creative Production Flow

1 Top Ads



- Monitor trending creatives
- Analyze high-conversion factors
- Extract opportunity points

2 Script Generation



- Use AI to generate story scripts
- Set conflict and reversals
- Output dialogue and voice-over

3 Storyboard Breakdown



- Break down shot structure
- Mark shot duration
- Output storyboard script

4 Visual Asset Generation



- Use AI to generate visuals, motion, and voice
- Match style and pacing
- Batch output creative packs

5 Performance Feedback



- Track creative performance
- Attribute conversion data
- Extract winning elements
- Iterate visual style
- Expand more variants

6 Next Week Iteration



- Optimize scripts and pacing
- Iterate visual style
- Expand more variants

Data drives continuous optimization

Core Judgment



Creatives should not rely on plain gameplay capture. **Cat emotions**, **sushi-sorting failures**, and **shop growth** should become reusable creative themes.

Upgrade from manual inspiration to an **AI-driven** creative production pipeline.



5.1 Ad Creative Themes

1 Cat Store Manager



Stray Cat → Sort Sushi → Upgrade Store → Cat Wears Chef Outfit

2 1% IQ Challenge



Deliberately Misplace Sushi → Cat Gets Angry → Show the Correct Solution

3 ASMR Healing Sort



Sushi Sliding Sound → Plate Chime → Cat Purring

4 Cat Customers Break Down



Cat Waits in Anticipation → Player Makes a Mistake → Complete the Order → Cat Becomes Happy



Creative themes should revolve around cat emotions, sorting failures, and store growth — not plain screen recording.



5.2 Creative Direction by Region



United States

Core Direction

IQ Challenge / Fake Fail /
Live-action Reaction

Goal

Boost CTR and reduce CPI

Key Points

Direct copy, fast pace,
clear failure feedback



Japan

Core Direction

Cat Stories / Soothing ASMR /
Exquisite Shop Growth

Goal

Improve CVR and D7 retention

Key Points

Localized Japanese copy,
less exaggerated failure,
emphasize cuteness and collection



Southeast Asia

Core Direction

Low-threshold tutorials /
Rewarded coins / Fast onboarding

Goal

Low CPI to supplement IAA traffic

Key Points

Emphasize free, simple,
instantly understandable,
local language



The same product offering requires different creative expressions across different markets.



5.3 UA Channel Strategy

TikTok
35%

- Validate hooks, UGC, short videos
- Target CPI: US < $3.0 / JP < $3.2
- D30 ROAS > 35%

Meta
35%

- Stable conversion, lookalike, ROAS calibration
- D30 ROAS ⩾ 40%

Unity
15%

- In-game traffic, supplement IAA users
- Rewarded video view rate > 55%

AppLovin
15%

- Mid-/late-stage IAA traffic and mediation synergy
- IAA ARPDAU +10%

🎯 **Cold-start principle: small budget, many creatives, fast elimination — do not pursue full payback from a single channel on day one.**

6.0 IAA Monetization Principles

> “Ads are a reward exchange, **not a forced interruption.**”



1 Prioritize rewarded videos

Let players actively choose to watch ads for rewards.



2 Use low-frequency interstitials

Show ads only after victory, between levels, and other natural pauses.



3 Do not interrupt core actions

Do not show ads while moving sushi, thinking about sorting, or completing orders.



4 Establish understanding and emotional connection

Establish understanding and emotional connection first.



IAA design should **serve players’ real needs**, **not add more frustration**.



6.1 Ad Placements in Core Gameplay



1 Continue After Failure

Rewarded Video

Continue after a failed run and keep trying.

2 Hint When Stuck

After 45–60 seconds of inactivity, provide a hint or undo to help continue thinking.

3 Double Rewards

Rewarded Video

At victory settlement, double gold / ingredients / affection to reduce frustration.

4 Win Streak Protection

When a streak fails, allow continuation to maintain achievement.

5 Continue Your Streak

When a streak fails, allow continuation to maintain achievement.





Ads at entry points only appear when players need help, want rewards, or risk losing progress.





6.2 Ad Placements in Store Management & Cat Raising

Sushi Store Management Ads

Offline Income x2
Watch an ad to claim double offline income.

Upgrade Speed-up
Watch an ad to complete the upgrade countdown instantly.

Order Refresh
Watch an ad to refresh the current order list immediately.

Ingredient Refill
Watch an ad to replenish missing ingredients immediately.

Extra Tip Reward
Watch an ad to receive an additional tip bonus.



Cat Raising Ads

Cat Food
Watch an ad to get a large amount of cat food.

Extra Interaction
Watch an ad to unlock one extra interaction chance.

Gallery Fragments
Watch an ad to obtain random gallery fragments.

Extend Rare Cat Stay
Watch an ad to extend the time a rare cat stays in the store.

Daily Cat Gift Box
Watch an ad to claim an extra daily cat gift box.



Ordinary sort games reward utility through ads; this project can turn ads into emotional rewards.

6.3 Ad Rhythm & Filtering

New User Phase

Levels 1–3	No ads shown
Levels 4–6	Only rewarded prompts are shown — optional, not mandatory
Levels 7–10	Continue-after-failure becomes available

Interstitial Rhythm

- At most one interstitial after every 3 victories
- Approx. 5 seconds, skippable

Dynamic Frequency

- Ad-sensitive users: once every 5 levels
- Users with consecutive failures: pause interstitials to avoid disturbance
- Paying users: reduce or remove interstitials

Content Filtering

- ⊗ Block adult content
- ⊗ Block gambling content
- ⊗ Block violent content
- ⊗ Block horror content
- ⊗ Block fake gameplay ads
- ⊗ Block forced-install ads
- ⊗ Block direct competitor ads

Ads must not appear at emotionally sensitive moments, especially immediately after failure or during the tutorial.

7.0 IAP Product System

Level Tool Packs

- Hint Tickets
- Ingredient Refill
- Speed-up Tickets
- Order Refresh

$0.99–$4.99

Resource Packs

- Coins
- Ingredients
- Speed-up Tickets
- Order Refresh

Cat Raising Packs

- Toys
- Interaction Tickets
- Speed-up Tickets
- Furniture

Collection & Cosmetics

- Gallery Completion
- Limited Skins
- Store Themes
- Furniture
- Cat Outfits
- BGM

Store Cosmetic Packs

- Store Themes
- Furniture
- Plate Skins
- Cat Outfits
- BGM

Remove Ads

$2.99–$4.99

Remove forced interstitials and banner ads.
Voluntary rewarded ads remain for extra rewards.



IAP does not sell level skip or stamina. It sells **efficiency**, **collection**, and **personalization**.



7.1 IAA + IAP Synergy



Example conversion scenarios



Ads are not the opposite of payment — they are the trial entrance for IAP value.

8.0 Commercial Rollout & Closed Loop

Launch Version Setup



Rewarded Ads

- Continue after failure
- Double rewards
- Double offline earnings



Interstitial

- At most once every 3 victories
- Approx. 5 seconds, skippable



IAP

- Remove Ads $2.99 – $4.99
- $0.99 Mini Pack
- Gold Pack, Cat Food Pack
- Starter Pack

Commercial Closed Loop Path



Low-Cost Validation
Light UA testing / validate core metrics



Retention Improvement
Optimize UX and levels / improve D1 and D7



LTV Growth
Increase pay rate and ARPPU / extend lifetime value



UA Scaling
Scale based on ROI / acquire more precise users



LiveOps Operations
Events, seasons, passes / continue monetization and activity



IP Accumulation
Build cat IP assets



Final Goal: Build a Hybrid Casual business model with verifiable ROI, sustainable UA, and long-term operations.